

Saitek R100 Sports Wheel

Features: Game port interface, wheel-mounted pedals, two buttons, floor gas brake pedals **Price:** Rs 2,250 **Contact:** Origin Marketing Pvt Ltd **Phone:** 022-28801335 **E-mail:** origin@vsnl.com **Web site:** www.saitek.com

The R100 Sports Wheel has a perfect set of features and performance. The design is very well-laid out with ample space and no cramping of buttons. The grip has a recess for the thumb at just the right place. The steering wheel uses a different granular material for the palm grips. Two buttons are placed within the reach of the thumb, and the two pedal switches are wheel mounted and can be used as excellent gear shifters.

The clamping mechanism holds the wheel firmly in place and requires just a minute to dismantle. The footboard can be dismantled from the main steering unit using a small RJ45 pin. The brake and the gas pedals use a stiff spring to provide optimum response, when pressed, requiring a firm push to the floor. The floorboard however, disappointingly skids a lot when called for duty.

Our R100 had a game port and we had a tough time detecting it and getting it to work properly in some games. We even had to download the drivers from the Web site. The wheel comes with a USB version that does away with these problems. With a price of Rs 2,250, the wheel is a good non-force feedback buy.



Saitek R100 Sports Wheel		B+
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	

Typhoon Power Wheel

Features: Large steering wheel, four programmable buttons, floor gas/brake pedals, a gear shifter knob, USB interface **Price:** Rs 1,650 **Contact:** Hitech Computers **Phone:** 022-24927323 **E-mail:** bom@hitechit.com **Web site:** www.anubisline.com

The Typhoon Power Wheel does not score well in the aesthetics department. However, the steering surface is coated with rubber for excellent grip and four buttons are mounted on the two spokes within easy reach. The highlight, though, is the presence of a gear shifter knob—the gears move as smooth as a hot knife through butter.

The footboard is large with big foot pedals and the surface is made rough by small plastic bubbles for a good grip. Good anchoring to the floor doesn't let the footboard skid even when slammed hard.

The steering wheel uses very stiff spring for centring and hence requires some effort to steer the car properly. The steering wheel is very comfortable due to its large size and is quite responsive. Disappointingly, the foot-

board is attached to the main steering wheel and cannot be detached or dismantled.

At Rs 1,650 it may seem a little steep, considering the build quality and features it offers.



Typhoon Power Wheel		B+
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	

Saitek R440 Force Feedback

Features: Wheel-mounted pedals, four programmable buttons, floor gas and brake pedals **Price:** Rs 6,999 **Contact:** Origin Marketing Pvt Ltd **Phone:** 022-28801335 **E-mail:** origin@vsnl.com **Web site:** www.saitek.com

The Saitek R440 is a mean machine with an aggressive design. The four programmable buttons are placed on the wheel within easy reach. However, the grip is not too firm and the wheel feels a tad cramped.

The footboard is made up of two parts and the pedal assembly can be dismantled from the extended board. One nagging problem that we came across was that the footboard lacks any anchoring material. It skids when playing—an obviously irritating distraction during an intense race. Moreover, the gas and brake pedal can do with better spring tension to elevate the experience.

The force feedback effects were good but not very precise, and the wheel made an irritating noise when used. The SGE programming utility bundled along, also lacks user-friendliness and is tedious to work with. The Saitek R440 Force Feedback wheel is a good gaming tool that lacks the refinement that one sees in Logitech devices. At Rs 6,999 it provokes a second thought, especially since other wheels from the same house pack more features at the same price.



Saitek R440 Force Feedback Wheel		B-
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	

Typhoon Racer Wheel

Features: Wheel-mounted gas and brake buttons, 14 programmable buttons, four P.O.V button and USB interface **Price:** Rs 1,080 **Contact:** Hitech Computers **Phone:** 022-24927323 **E-mail:** bom@hitechit.com **Web site:** www.anubisline.com

At first sight, this wheel gives the impression of being cumbersome and clumsy given the thousand-odd buttons thrown on its surface. The buttons for acceleration and brake are mounted on the wheel, and can be operated using the thumb. Though this is good since the buttons are ideally placed just under the thumb, Typhoon did a somersault by not providing the right type of buttons. These buttons require to be squeezed hard to keep the acceleration on and the same goes for the brake.

The centre console is a button farm with four P.O.V (point of view) buttons and 14 other programmable buttons. The Joystick is centred by stiff springs that jump into action the moment you turn the wheel to either side. The base is small with four suction cups for grip, yet the device slips on a smooth surface.

A price tag of Rs 1,080 hits the sweet spot. The game port version of this wheel is also available for Rs 990, but with less buttons. We advice you to stick to the USB version since it is simple to install and gets detected quite easily.



Typhoon Racer Wheel		B+
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	